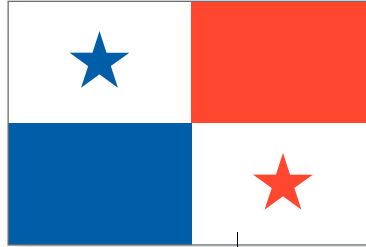


Panama

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 3, 1903 **Usage:** National and Civil

Although inspired by the Stars and Stripes, the stars and quarters are said to represent the two main political parties



Blue was the color of the Conservatives and red that of the Liberals

White symbolizes peace in the country

North America



Panama, originally a province of Colombia, was detached in 1903 to secure the building of the Panama Canal within a US-controlled zone.

The first flag, proposed in 1903, consisted of seven horizontal stripes of red and yellow, with a blue canton containing two golden suns, joined by a narrow line to depict the oceans to be united by the Panama Canal.

However this was not accepted by the Panamanian leader, Manuel A. Guerrero, whose family designed a

new flag. Although clearly modeled on the US flag, the stars and quarters are said to stand for the rival political parties, and the white for the peace in which they operate.

The coat of arms reflects Panama's transition from civil war to peace, and the increased prosperity this promised the people.

ARMS OF PANAMA

The shield depicts tools, weapons, a cornucopia, and a winged wheel, which together symbolize a move from war, to peace and prosperity



*The national motto—
“Pro Mundi Beneficio”
meaning “For the Benefit
of the World”*

*The northern and southern
hemispheres joined by the
Panama Canal*